

Setting up **Codex and GitHub** for your child

This term your child builds real browser games and a club website with an AI helper. They need two accounts before class starts. This guide shows you how to create both with **Continue with Google**. It takes about 25 minutes.

ACCOUNT	WHAT IT DOES	NEEDED BY	COST
ChatGPT (for Codex)	Codex is the AI helper inside VS Code, the program where your child writes code. It signs in with a ChatGPT account on the Plus plan.	Week 1	US\$20/month
GitHub	Saves your child's projects online each week and gives their games a real web address.	Week 2	Free
Vercel (later)	Puts the club website online. Made in class with Continue with GitHub . Nothing to do now.	Week 9	Free



Do everything on your child's laptop

Create both accounts **in the web browser on the Windows or Mac laptop your child brings to class**, and leave ChatGPT and GitHub signed in there. Signing up on your phone or another computer does not sign in your child's laptop. **Chromebooks, iPads, and other tablets won't work:** VS Code and Codex run only on Windows and Mac.

Whose name goes on the accounts?

ChatGPT and GitHub allow account holders only if they are **13 or older**. Whoever owns the accounts is the **account holder** in the steps that follow.

UNDER 13 You own them

Create both accounts with **your** Google account, and enter **your** name and birthday, never your child's. Your child uses the accounts with your permission.

13 OR OLDER Your choice

You decide. Your teen can sign up with **their own** Google account and birthday, or use yours. If they have their own account, buy ChatGPT Plus **on their account**. A Plus plan on yours doesn't cover theirs.



First class: please stay nearby for 30 to 60 minutes

Plan to wait in the waiting area or lobby for the first 30 to 60 minutes of the first class. Some laptops hit a setup problem on day one, like a sign-in that needs the account holder's phone or password. With you close by, we can fix it on the spot.

PART 1

ChatGPT account and Codex

Do this before Week 1 · about 20 minutes · on your child's laptop

The account holder's Google account

The same one for ChatGPT and GitHub. If it's yours, a new one just for class keeps your email private.

Not a school Google account

School accounts often block outside apps, and the school controls them.

The account holder's phone

Google may ask to approve the sign-in on it.

A credit card

For ChatGPT Plus, US\$20 a month plus tax. Cancel any time; the course runs about 4 months.

1 Create the ChatGPT account and get Plus

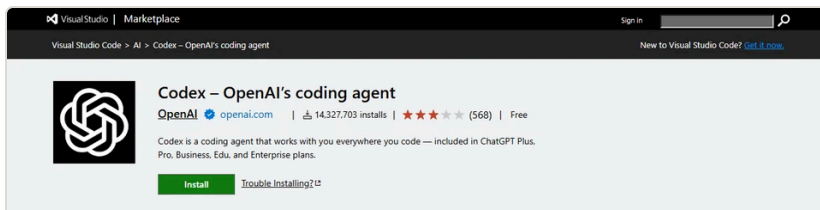
10 min

1. In the laptop's browser (Chrome, Edge, or Safari), go to chatgpt.com and click **Sign up**.
2. Click **Continue with Google** and choose the account holder's Google account.
3. Enter the account holder's real name and birthday, then click **Continue**.
4. Click your name in the bottom-left corner, then **Upgrade plan**.
5. Choose **Plus** (US\$20/month, not Go or Pro), enter your card, and subscribe.
6. Leave ChatGPT **signed in** in this browser. Don't sign out.

2 Connect Codex

10 min · recommended

1. Install **VS Code** for free from code.visualstudio.com. On Windows, tick **Create a desktop icon**.
2. Open VS Code. Click **Extensions** on the left bar (four small squares) and search **Codex**.
3. Install **Codex – OpenAI's coding agent**. Check that the publisher is **OpenAI** with a blue check. Look-alike extensions exist.



The correct extension. It works with the ChatGPT Plus plan from Step 1.

4. Open the Codex panel on the right side of VS Code. Can't see it? Press **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **P** (Mac: **Cmd**), type **Codex: Open Codex Sidebar**, and press **Enter**.
5. Click **Sign in with ChatGPT**. In the browser that opens, click **Continue with Google**, choose the same Google account, and approve.
6. Go back to VS Code. When the Codex panel shows a box to type in, Codex is ready.

No time for Step 2? Your child does it in class in Week 1. Because Step 1 left the browser signed in, the Codex sign-in takes one click.

PART 2**GitHub account**

Do this before Week 2 · about 10 minutes · on your child's laptop

1 Create the GitHub account

5 min

1. On your child's laptop, in the same browser, go to github.com/signup.
2. Click **Continue with Google** and choose the **same** Google account you used for ChatGPT.
3. Pick a username (see below). If asked for a country, choose **Canada**.
4. Complete any puzzle, or enter the code GitHub emails you.
5. Leave GitHub **signed in** in this browser. Don't sign out.

The username is public. It appears in the web address of every project, for example `pixel-fox.github.io/my-arcade`.

GOOD USERNAMES

pixel-fox · sam-makes-games · jl-codes

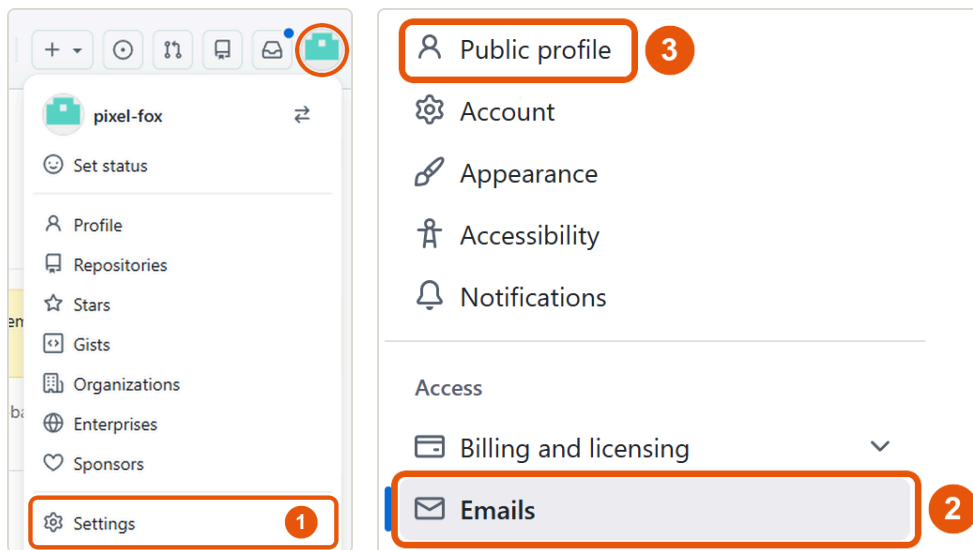
AVOID

samantha-lee-2015 · sam-oakridge-ps. No full names, birth years, schools, or towns.

2 Hide your email address

2 min

1. Click the profile picture in the top-right corner, then **Settings** ①.
2. In the left menu, click **Emails** ②. Make sure **Keep my email addresses private** is switched **On**. Your email then stays hidden when your child saves work.



Profile menu

Settings, left menu

Keep my email addresses private

We'll remove your public profile email and use `12345678+pixel-fox@users.noreply.github.com` when performing web-based Git operations (e.g. edits and merges) and sending email on your behalf. If you want command line Git operations to use your private email you must [set your email in Git](#).

Previously authored commits associated with a public email will remain public.

On ☒

Emails page: the switch should say **On**.

3 Keep the public profile blank

2 min

1. In the left menu, click **Public profile** 3.
2. Leave **Name**, **Company**, and **Location** empty. Keep the default picture; don't upload a photo of your child.
3. If you had to clear a field, click **Update profile** at the bottom of the form.

Public profile

Name

Your name may appear around GitHub where you contribute or are mentioned. You can remove it at any time.

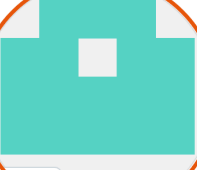
Public email

Select a verified email to display

You have set your email address to private. To toggle email privacy, go to [email settings](#) and uncheck "Keep my email address private."

Bio

Profile picture



Edit

Company

You can @mention your company's GitHub organization to link it.

Location

Public profile page (middle fields skipped). Everything outlined should stay empty or default.

Good to know

What is public?

Your child's GitHub projects are public, so anyone with the link can play the games and see the code. That's how they get a real web address to share with family. Keep full names, photos, and school names out of project files.

What if Codex hits its limit?

Plus covers normal class use. If your child reaches the limit, it resets on its own. Until then, they pair with a classmate. There's no need to buy Pro.

ChatGPT asks to confirm age?

OpenAI sometimes checks an account holder's age. The account holder completes the check. Teen accounts get extra safety settings.

Can I see what my child does?

If the ChatGPT account is yours, yes: chats appear in your history. If your teen has their own account, no. Linking accounts adds parental controls, but you can't read their chats. GitHub shows every save your child makes.

Already pay for Plus?

If your child uses your account, no second plan is needed, but they will see your chat history. A teen with their own account needs Plus on it.

Signed out in class?

If Google needs the account holder's phone to sign back in, your child saves the work and uploads it at home with you. Staying signed in avoids this.

Screenshots are from a demo account. GitHub's pages may look slightly different over time.

Before the first class

Check that both sites are signed in

On your child's laptop, open the browser and visit `chatgpt.com`, then `github.com`. Both should open already signed in, with no password prompt. If either asks you to sign in, do it now while you're home.

Setup checklist

BEFORE WEEK 1

- ☐ Windows or Mac laptop ready (not a Chromebook or tablet)
- ☐ Account holder chosen, Google account ready
- ☐ ChatGPT account made with Google sign-in
- ☐ ChatGPT **Plus** active on that account
- ☐ ChatGPT signed in on the laptop's browser
- ☐ Codex signed in inside VS Code (recommended)

BEFORE WEEK 2

- ☐ GitHub account made with Google sign-in
- ☐ Email privacy switched On in GitHub settings
- ☐ GitHub signed in on the laptop's browser

FIRST CLASS

- ☐ Laptop charged, charger packed
- ☐ You stay in the lobby for the first 30 to 60 minutes

GitHub username for your child to bring to Week 2: _____

What happens in the first class

0-10 min

Explore the arcade

Your child plays the teacher's demo games.

10-35 min

Set up the tools

VS Code, Codex, and Live Server on the laptop, with the ChatGPT sign-in.

WE MAY CALL YOU

35-60 min

Build a first game

A three-sentence game plan, one prompt to Codex, then play it.

Setup problems show up in the first half of class, so please stay in the lobby for the first 30 to 60 minutes.